



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Class: M/W, 9:35 – 10:50AM

Location: Woodburn Hall, Room 004

Instructor: Hannah Ridner

Contact: hrridner@iu.edu

Office Hours: Mondays, 11:00 AM – 1:00PM | Sycamore Hall, Room 300

Course Content2

Course Materials2

Assignment Descriptions.....3

 Attendance & Participation (50 points).....3

 In-Class Activities (45 points)3

 Exercises (100 points)3

 Media Reviews (100 points)4

 Exams (100 points)4

 Final Project (105 points).....4

Grading.....5

Policies (Course & IUB)6

 Communication.....6

 Attendance.....6

 Make-up Work and Late Assignments6

 Generative AI:7

Student Services9

 Accessibility.....9

 Academic Support9

 Support Services9

 Mental Health Care/Counseling Services 10

Course Schedule 10



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Course Description & Outcomes

This is an introductory course covering topics in the study of criminology and the criminal justice system. This course will be broken down into four main sections: 1) General crime & criminal justice, 2) policing, 3) courts, and 4) corrections. Major topics such as the historical background, structure, functions, and operations of the criminal justice system in the United States will be covered.

Outcomes of Course:

1. Introduce foundational concepts of criminal justice in America (i.e., major components/terms)
2. Examine how these concepts apply within the American criminal justice institutions (i.e., police, courts, corrections, and law)
3. Develop critical thinking related to issues within the American criminal justice system

Additionally, this course prepares students for more generalized skills in critical thinking, practical applications of outside resources to the criminal justice system, and basic inquiry.

Course Content

The focus of this course is the criminal legal system. Within that focus, I have selected class materials that present a variety of topics and arguments, including equality, debates on the purposes and outcomes of the justice system, and critically evaluating strengths/weaknesses of the justice system. It is (likely) that connections between our course and current and/or historical events outside the classroom will come up in (lectures/class and/or discussions/assignments). The ability to draw and analyze connections among ideas and events is a core skill in a liberal arts education and will help you in your life beyond IU.

Course Materials

Textbook:

MindTap Introduction to Criminal Justice, 17th Edition
Larry J. Siegel; John L. Worrall
ISBN: 9780357631065



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Access to the text and the rest of the Digital Learning Tool was covered through IU e-Texts and by the course fee you paid. Check Canvas for access & instructions.

Canvas:

This course will use Canvas for assignments, exams, grades, any extra materials (i.e., articles), and other important information. Students should consistently be engaged with Canvas as any important announcements will be updated on the Canvas page.

Assignment Descriptions

Attendance & Participation (50 points)

Students who attend 75% of classes (~around 20 classes) will earn all 50 points, and a percentage of those 50 may be earned depending on how many classes are attended. If you miss class, **there are no makeup points available** (*regardless of the reason*) as there is an opportunity to receive all points with several absences. This includes sickness, school-sanctioned events, and/or religious exemptions. There is an opportunity to receive all credit while still missing class. If you attend more than 75%, you will receive extra credit.

Participation: No credit is given for simply showing up and not participating (i.e., participating when able in Menti, class discussion, paying attention), and no credit is given if you are consistently late (i.e., more than a few minutes).

In-Class Activities (45 points)

There will be four in-class activities throughout the semester, **with three counting towards your final grade**. You should expect to attend three of these, as there is no opportunity for make-ups. These are noted on the Course Schedule, and if any dates change, you will be notified in advance so that you can prepare to attend. These activities could be guest speakers and/or group activities. These will be worth 15 points each.

Exercises (100 points)

There will be twelve exercises throughout the semester, **with ten counting towards your final grade**. Two exercises (the lowest) will be dropped. If you miss an exercise, consider that one of your dropped exercises. As these are designed for course material



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

engagement each week, you should be keeping up with these. Each exercise is worth 10 points.

Media Reviews (100 points)

There will be three media reviews throughout the semester, **with two counting towards your final grade**. These are designed to engage with a specific part of the criminal justice system, and will be offered for (1) policing, (2) courts, and (3) corrections and will consist of reviewing pieces of media and answering guided questions. The media you will use is all free for you and will consist of an engaging documentary, case tracking/articles, and a podcast (transcriptions included). These are 50 points each.

Exams (100 points)

There will be two exams throughout the course. These are *not* cumulative and will be over the main modules [(1) intro/policing and (2) courts/corrections]. All exams will be online, open-book, and consist of multiple choice questions, true/false, and short answer. These are 50 points each.

Final Project (105 points)

The final project for this course consists of three parts:

1. **Topic Selection (10 points)**. Submit your chosen topic for approval. Choose a topic related to the criminal justice system — something you're genuinely curious about, whether tied to your major, a career interest, or a current issue you want to understand more deeply.
2. **Fact Sheet (70 points)**. Create a fact sheet on your chosen topic. This is a short, creative document (not a traditional research paper) that presents key facts, data, and context on a criminal justice issue of your choosing, clearly and accessibly. Details and examples will be provided in the assignment description.
3. **Presentation (25 points)**. You will present to me (the instructor) about your topic as an informal, short presentation (think "elevator pitch" — a few sentences on what you found and why it matters). Presentations will be posted around the room for other classmates to view and you will also answer their questions. These questions are ones you will ask other students about their presentations as well. More information will follow via Canvas/class.



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Grading

Assignment	Points	Percentage
Attendance	50	10%
In-Class Activities x3	45	9%
Exams x2	100	20%
<i>Final Project</i>	-	21%
Fact Sheet	70	-
Presentation	25	-
Topic Selection	10	-
Media Reviews x2	100	20%
Exercises x10	100	20%
Total Points	500	-

Final letter grades will be assigned according to the University's standard grading scale:

A+	97 to 100%	C	73 to 76.9%
A	93 to 96.9%	C-	70 to 72.9%
A-	90 to 92.9%	D+	67 to 69.9%
B+	87 to 89.9%	D	63 to 66.9%
B	83 to 86.9%	D-	60 to 62.9%
B-	80 to 82.9%	F	below 60%
C+	77 to 79.9%		-

*Grades will be assigned in a timely manner. If you have questions or concerns about your grade(s) and believe that I should review them, you should submit a written request over email within one week after the grade has been given. Final grades will have 24 hours before being sent to the registrar.



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Policies (Course & IUB)

Communication

Reach out if something comes up — a life circumstance, a question about the material, confusion about an assignment, whatever it is. It's much easier for me to help if I know about a problem early, rather than after a deadline has already passed.

Best way to reach me: Email, at hrridner@iu.edu.

Response time: I'll respond within 24–48 hours on weekdays. Since this course is asynchronous, I don't check email on weekends, so a message sent Friday afternoon may not get a reply until Monday — plan accordingly if you have a question about a Sunday deadline.

Office hours: Monday, 11am–1pm. Try to let me know if you're coming, if possible (but not required).

Attendance

Students are responsible for keeping up with the material covered in each class. While I understand that it is not always possible to attend class, you are responsible for making arrangements to get notes from a classmate to make up for what you have missed. I will not initiate contact with students about making up missed work. *Note that there are no makeups for attendance (for any reason), as leeway is already built into attendance points.* Attending 75% of the class (around 20 classes) will receive all points.

Make-up Work and Late Assignments

***Note: No makeup work will be allowed if grades are already posted for the assignment**

In-Class activities & attendance can NOT be made up.

Please email me *prior* to missing something when possible. If you are unable to turn in an assignment on time, **please get in touch with me as soon as possible**. For example, if you are ill, do *not* wait to contact me after you are better to let me know you missed an assignment. Please also note that last-minute issues (i.e., computer issues) do not necessarily constitute a reason for an extension as all work is open for an extended period.



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Late Assignments: These will be subject to a grading penalty. There will be a 10% grade deduction for each day the assignment is late, and assignments submitted *over 3 days beyond the due date* will not be eligible for credit.

Copyright

You should consider all materials in the course, including my lectures, power point slides, assignments, and notes as being subject to copyright protection. These are designed for your individual use during this course and should not be disseminated to others in any way without my express written permission.

Class Conduct

Students are expected to attend and be prepared for all classes, arrive on time, be actively engaged in class discussion and activities, and refrain from any disruptive behavior (which includes talking during the lecture). Participation in the course should maintain a positive work and learning environment.

***See the Student Code of Conduct Section on This: [Personal Misconduct](#)**

Academic Integrity & Misconduct

Academic dishonesty will not be tolerated and any violations will be reported to the Dean of Students. You are responsible for being attentive to and observant of University policies about academic honesty. Sanctions for academic misconduct will include a grade of zero on the assignment, reduction in your final course grade with the possibility of a failing grade in the course depending on circumstances, among other possibilities.

Honesty requires that any ideas or materials taken from another source for either written or oral use must be fully acknowledged. Offering the work of someone else as one's own is plagiarism.

***See the Student Code of Conduct Section on This: [Academic Misconduct](#)**

Generative AI: A primary goal of this course is to develop *your* unique voice and critical thinking skills. I genuinely want to hear *your* opinions, perspectives, and authentic insights. Because our assignments are designed to stretch your personal analytical skills, AI or large language models cannot replicate or replace the learning that happens when



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

you do this work yourself. Therefore, the use of generative AI is prohibited for any assignment in this class. If AI use is suspected, you will face an oral defense of your work, a zero on the assignment, and a referral for violating the IU Code of Student Conduct.

Note Selling and Online Course Materials

I have the exclusive right to distribute, modify, post, and reproduce course materials, including all written materials, study guides, lectures, assignments, exercises, and exams. Some of the course content may be downloadable for students who may only have intermittent access to the internet, but you should not distribute, post, or alter a faculty member's intellectual property. The use of technologies for audio or video recording of lectures and other classroom activities is NOT allowed. Violations of this policy will be reported to the Dean of Students as academic misconduct.

Title IX and Sexual Misconduct

Title IX and our own Sexual Misconduct policy prohibit sexual misconduct. If you have experienced sexual misconduct, or know someone who has, the University can help. I encourage you to visit [Stop Sexual Violence website](#) to learn more. If you are seeking help and would like to speak to someone confidentially, you can make an appointment to receive [confidential resources](#). It is also important that you know that Title IX and University policy require me to share any information brought to my attention about potential sexual misconduct, with the campus Deputy Title IX Coordinator or IU's Title IX Coordinator. In that event, those individuals will work to ensure that appropriate measures are taken and resources are made available.

Bias-Based Incident Reporting

Bias-based incident reports can be made by students, faculty, and staff. Any act of discrimination or harassment based on race, ethnicity, religious affiliation, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, or disability can be reported through any of the options: 1) email biasincident@indiana.edu or incident@indiana.edu; 2) call the Dean of Students Office at (812) 855-8188 or 3) use the IU mobile App (m.iu.edu). Reports can be made anonymously.



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Student Services

Accessibility

Indiana University Bloomington will provide reasonable accessibility measures (accommodations) to any student with a qualifying medical condition under the ADA. Accessibility measures are available for placement testing, exams, in-class support, and campus mobility. Whether you have a permanent or temporary impairment, you can register for services through Accessible Educational Services. (See [IU's policy here](#) & the AES office [here](#)).

Academic Support

- [Math](#)
- [Writing](#)
- [Libraries and Research:](#)
- [Technology](#)

For more information, visit: [IU Online Academic Support](#)

University Information Technology Services (UITS)

Students can also find answers to frequently asked technology questions in the [IU Knowledge Base](#).

Get no-cost access to hundreds of software programs and applications (including Microsoft Office or Adobe Creative Cloud) through [IUware](#) and [IUanyWare](#). All you need is your IU email address.

Use IUware to install software directly onto your hard drive. Use IUanyWare to stream 400+ apps on your desktop or through the mobile app with your IU login.

Support Services

IUB has various listed support services, which you can find [here](#).

These include access to food, financial support, [student legal services](#), childcare/family services, cultural centers, and other counseling services.



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

Mental Health Care/Counseling Services

[CAPS](#), [TimelyCare](#) (free, virtual mental health support), and the [counseling/wellness clinic](#).

Course Schedule

This is the tentative course schedule which is *subject to change* when needed. Any days with “TBD” will be updated when possible (this does not mean there is not class – this will be updated ASAP).

****In-Class Activities will be announced later in the semester with official dates!****

Week	Date	Content	Due Dates <i>All due at 11:59 PM</i>
Week 1	Mon, Aug 24	Class Introductions (syllabus, course overview)	
	Wed, Aug 26	What is Crime & the CJ System?	Exercise 1 due Fri 8/28
Week 2	Mon, Aug 31	Policing I: Police Organization, Role & Function	
	Wed, Sept 2	Policing II: Policing Strategies	Exercise 2 due Fri 9/4
Week 3	Mon, Sept 7	NO CLASS — Labor Day	
	Wed, Sept 9	Guest Speaker: Sergeant from the Indiana State Troopers	Exercise 3 due Fri 9/11 <i>In-Class Activity #1</i>
Week 4	Mon, Sept 14	Policing III: Policing Technology	
	Wed, Sept 16	*Documentary Day (screening for Media Review 1) Tentative	Exercise 4 due Fri 9/18; Media Review 1 (Policing) due Sun 9/20
Week 5	Mon, Sept 21	Policing IV: Issues in Policing	
	Wed, Sept 23	Policing IV: Issues in Policing (cont.)	Exercise 5 due Fri 9/25
Week 6	Mon, Sept 28	Policing V: Policing and the Law	
	Wed, Sept 30	Policing V: Policing and the Law (cont.)	Exercise 6 due Fri 10/2
Week 7	Mon, Oct 5	EXAM #1 (Introduction + Policing) — ONLINE	Exam #1 due Mon 10/05
	Wed, Oct 7	Courts I: Specialty & Problem-Solving Courts	
Week 8	Mon, Oct 12	Courts II: Court Structure	
	Wed, Oct 14	Guest Speaker: Ted Polley (IU Librarian) Courts III: Court Personnel (pending time)	<i>In-Class Activity #2</i> Exercise 7 due Fri 10/16
Week 9	Mon, Oct 19	Courts IV: Pretrial Procedures	



P100: Introduction to Criminal Justice

	Wed, Oct 21	Courts V: Trial Process + Jury Selection	Exercise 8 due Fri 10/23; Media Review 2 (Courts) due Sun 10/25
Week 10	Mon, Oct 26	Courts VI: Punishment & Sentencing	
	Wed, Oct 28	Courts VII: Sentencing (cont.): Death Penalty & Wrongful Convictions	Exercise 9 due Fri 10/30; Topic Selection due Sun 11/1
Week 11	Mon, Nov 2	Corrections I: Community Corrections	
	Wed, Nov 4	Guest Speaker: City Homelessness Response Coordinator + Downtown Resource Officer Supervisor	Exercise 10 due Fri 11/6 <i>In-Class Activity #3</i>
Week 12	Mon, Nov 9	Corrections II: Prisons & Jails: History	
	Wed, Nov 11	Corrections III: Private Prisons, Prison Labor, Cost of Incarceration & Prison Programs	Exercise 11 due Fri 11/13; Media Review 3 (Corrections) due Sun 11/15
Week 13	Mon, Nov 16	Corrections IV: Prison Life: Conditions, Healthcare, Rights, Oversight & the Stanford Prison Experiment	
	Wed, Nov 18	NO CLASS – Instructor Gone for Conference Work on Final Projects	Exercise 12 due Fri 11/20
Week 14	Mon, Nov 23	NO CLASS — Thanksgiving Break	-
	Wed, Nov 25	NO CLASS — Thanksgiving Break	-
Week 15	Mon, Nov 30	Corrections V: Reentry & Recidivism	
	Wed, Dec 2	EXAM #2 (Courts + Corrections) — ONLINE	Exam #2 due Wed 12/02
Week 16	Mon, Dec 7	Final Presentations — Day 1	Final Project due Sun 12/6
	Wed, Dec 9	Final Presentations — Day 2	

See [here](#) for a full schedule of IUB dates | **September 7th**: Labor Day | **October 9th**: Fall Break | **November 22nd**
– **29th**: Thanksgiving Break | **December 14th – 18th**: Finals Week